Maddie Cole

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Education

MSc Environmental Economics & Climate Change, London School of Economics 2019
MA Economics, University of Montana 2017
BA Economics, University of Montana 2014

Professional experience

Engagement Manager January 2025 - Present
Mode Economics, London, United Kingdom (remote)

- Co-founded a boutique economic consultancy focused on climate adaptation planning and resilience financing; grew the team from 4 to 10 members within 9 months
- Develop and coordinate client engagement, proposal development, and project scoping; established company-wide processes for data management, project budgeting, and stakeholder communication
- Lead and manage 2-3 quantitatively rigorous projects concurrently, including econometric analyses, cost–benefit assessments, and scenario planning, delivering insights for decision-makers
- Project examples: Directed a program estimating the health and economic impacts of extreme heat on vulnerable women, producing policy-relevant findings to inform adaptation planning, advised a climate-data provider on revenue diversification through licensing, developing a go-to-market plan, pricing considerations, and product-market fit recommendations

Associate (Senior Economist) June 2022 - Sept 2024
McKinsey & Company (formerly Vivid Economics), London, United Kingdom

- Managed project delivery for strategic clients (including top-five global agribusiness and food retailers), which included setting out long-term and day-to-day workplans, leading check-ins, tracking and reporting progress, delegating tasks, and owning manager-to-manager client relationships
- Led development of methodologies and bespoke modeling tools, including sensitivity analyses and auditing
- Synthesised complex and technical information into summary reports and presented recommendations to high-ranking government officials, corporate executives, and NGO leaders
- Project examples: Advised the UK government on how to crowd in private finance and scale ecosystem service markets by applying blended finance models, developed a workplan to scale a nature tech startup in Germany, synthesised studies on indirect land use to inform biofuel use decisions for a global agribusiness player

Project Fellow Feb 2023 - Feb 2024
World Economic Forum, Geneva, Switzerland

- Managed workplan and oversaw day-to-day tasks for a team of five, led weekly check-ins with WEF and McKinsey
- Liaised with C-suites at top companies to launch credit buyers' coalition (highlighted at NYCW, COP28, and Davos)
- Led the methodology, analysis, drafting, syndication, and launch of two high-profile public reports on the role of biodiversity credits in corporate nature strategies and a first-of-its-kind market projection for biodiversity credits

Economist Sept 2020 - June 2022
Vivid Economics, London, United Kingdom

- Managed small to medium-sized teams, built workstream workplans, developed methodologies, carried out technical analyses, drafted and edited reports, and created and delivered presentations for senior client leaders
- Led internal team dedicated to identifying and bidding for public contracts
- Project examples: Built a multi-hazard, multi-sector hazard model to estimate the socioeconomic cost of climate change scenarios in Jamaica, developed novel diet scenarios drawing on revealed preference studies on the elasticity of demand to estimate the health and environmental effects of carbon pricing scenarios, constructed a novel spatial indicator to highlight areas of high vulnerability and exposure to waterborne antimicrobial resistance

Analyst Sept 2019 - Sept 2020
Vivid Economics, London, United Kingdom

- Carried out technical analyses and scenario development, drafted reports, and created presentations of findings
- Project examples: Developed a spatial computable general equilibrium model of the Ethiopian economy to model the effects of flood and drought on productivity and migration, designed bespoke scenarios of climate change ambition and carried out analyses using a global partial equilibrium land use model (MAgPIE), built a framework and data-based tool to model fiscal risks stemming from climate-related disasters for the Ethiopian Ministry of Finance (and delivered a training on its use to 40 government officials)

Climate Change Fellow Jan - Aug 2018
National Audubon Society, Washington DC, USA

- Recommended strategic opportunities for advocacy in 30 states drawing legislative and public opinion data
- Carried out analysis and drafted materials to successfully advance solar energy bills in five states

Intern May - Aug 2017
United States Senate, Office of U.S. Senator Jon Tester (D-MT), Washington DC, USA

- Conducted research on health and education legislative topics and attended hearings on behalf of the Senator
- Directed constituents to state and federal resources, responded to correspondence, and led Capitol tours

Research experience

Dissertation, Restoring natural fire and the cost of suppression in American Wilderness Jan - Aug 2019
London School of Economics, London, United Kingdom

- Developed a novel instrumental variables strategy to estimate the effectiveness of a nature-based wildfire management policy in mitigating subsequent overlapping wildfires, which included building conceptual and empirical models
- Constructed a comprehensive spatial database comprising data on fire perimeter, point of ignition, conditions and cost; daily weather, drought indices, and air quality; distance to population and housing values, other values at risk like towns and priority watersheds, and firebreaks; and vegetation conditions
- Found that the policy reduced total and per-hectare suppression costs, but that if scaled up, it could reduce total suppression cost by as much as $1.05 million per fire.

Thesis, The Role of Behaviour in the Effectiveness of Indoor Air Pollution Interventions Aug 2015 - Dec 2017
University of Montana, Missoula, Montana, USA

- Leveraged panel data from a randomized placebo-controlled trial of wood stove changeout and air filter interventions to assess both the effectiveness of each intervention in improving air quality and whether participants adjusted their behavior in ways that could affect effectiveness of the interventions
- The research found that the air filters (but not the cleaner stoves) improved indoor air quality, but did not find that behavioral response varied by treatment group, nor that behavior had an impact of indoor air quality

Teaching experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Montana, Missoula, Montana, USA Aug 2015 - Dec 2016

- Handled course administration, held office hours, administered and graded assignments and exams, and assisted with lectures for introductory and intermediate microeconomics courses at the University of Montana

Awards

MSc Environmental Economics & Climate Change Best Overall Performance, LSE	2019
Grow with Google Challenge Scholarship & Nanodegree Scholarship, Google-Udacity	2018
Graduate Teaching Assistantship, The University of Montana	2014 - 2016
Dean's List Scholar, The University of Montana	2012 - 2014
Excellence in Photojournalism Scholarship, Melvin & Myrtle Lord Foundation	2013
Scholarship Recipient, Plum Creek Community	2012
Most Valuable Student Scholarship, ELKS Foundation	2012

Publications

- World Economic Forum. (2023). "Biodiversity Credits: A Guide to Support Early Use with High Integrity." White Paper. Available from: https://www3.weforum.org/docs/WEF_Biodiversity_Credits_A_Guide_to_Support_Early_Use_with_High_Integrity_2023.pdf
- World Economic Forum. (2023). "Biodiversity Credits: Demand Analysis and Market Outlook." Insight Report. Available from: https://www3.weforum.org/docs/WEF_2023_Biodiversity_Credits_Demand_Analysis_and_Market_Outlook.pdf
- NatureFinance. (2022). "Finance, Nature, and Food Transitions: The impact of potential financial climate and nature risk repricing on normative outcomes for food systems." Report. Available from: https://www.naturefinance.net/wp-content/uploads/2022/09/FinanceNatureandFoodTransitions.pdf
- International Bank for Reconstruction and Development, The World Bank. (2021). "Jamaica's Long-Term Climate Change Strategy Recommendations." Final Report. Available from: https://documents1.worldbank.org/curated/en/394231631778039389/pdf/Jamaica-s-Long-Term-Climate-Change-Strategy-Recommendations.pdf
- Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia Ministry of Finance. (2021). "Guidelines for quantifying disaster-related fiscal risks in Ethiopia." Report. Available from: https://www.opml.co.uk/files/Publications/a2422-build

ing-resilience-ethiopia/guidelines-disaster-related-fiscal-risk.pdf?noredirect=1

- World Economic Forum. (2021). "Antimicrobial Resistance and Water: The risks and costs for economies and societies." Briefing Paper. Available from: https://www3.weforum.org/docs/WEF_Antimicrobial_Resistance_and_Water_2021.pdf
- Orbitas. (2020). "Transition Scenarios for Tropical Agriculture." Report. Available from: https://orbitas.finance/wp-content/uploads/2020/11/Transition-Scenarios-for-Tropical-Agriculture_Final-2020.pdf

Languages and technical skills

- English (native), French (B2)
- MS suite including Excel formulas, pivot tables, formatting, and VBA (advanced), R including spatial analysis (advanced), Git (intermediate), GAMS (advanced), ArcGIS/QGIS (advanced), Stata (advanced)